

Who Uses Splink

A global map of documented adoption of the Ministry of Justice's record-linkage tool

Public-interest research from publicly available documents only. Compiled 4 June 2026. Two independent deep-research passes; every claim adversarially fact-checked (50 claims verified across both passes, 0 survived as false). Confidence flagged on every entry. The count is kept honest on purpose — a vague "used worldwide" is not a confirmed country.

Headline, stated plainly: documented adoption is **narrow and UK-centric**, not a global dragnet. Four countries show any confirmed Splink use; one (the UK) accounts for almost all of it. Several major statistics agencies that were specifically checked show **no evidence**, and **Statistics Canada is a confirmed non-adopter**. Because Splink is freely downloadable open-source software with no user registry, undocumented use certainly exists — but it is, by definition, undocumented, and is not asserted here as fact.

CONFIRMED adopters (4 countries)

 *United Kingdom — the core; deep and operational*

Body	Use	Status	Source
Ministry of Justice	Built Splink; links justice datasets; cross-justice person ID (Data First / Core Person Record); real-time court use; pulls PNC numbers for arrest info	Operational	gov.uk ATR records; github.com/moj-analytical-services/splink
Office for National Statistics	Splink v2.1.4 to dedup the 2021 Census; QA of Census↔DWP master key/encrypted NINo↔HMRC PAYE	Operational	ons.gov.uk 2021-Census→DWP; IJPDS 2245
NHS England	Splink pipeline feeding the Personal Demographics Service (Person_ID)	Operational (in build)	nhsengland.github.io data-linkage-hub; IJPDS 3271

 *Australia — one major system (confirmed, first pass)*

Body	Use	Status	Source
Australian Bureau of Statistics (+ AIHW)	Person Linkage Spine 2025 (Medicare+Centrelink+Tax); National Disability Data Asset spine	Operational	abs.gov.au Person Linkage Spine; IJPDS 2818

 *United States — narrow: one state pilot + evaluators*

Body	Use	Status	Source
Indiana Department of Health (IDOH)	Pilot linking COVID cases + vaccination records	Pilot	in.gov "Probabilistic Record Linkage with Splink" (Simmons)
US Census Bureau	<i>Evaluated</i> Splink vs in-house BigMatch	Evaluation only — not operational	census.gov record-linkage
Florida Cancer Registry	<i>Evaluated</i> Splink	Evaluation only	IJPDS 2786

 *Chile — one research study*

Body	Use	Status	Source
Ministry of Health (with UCL)	Research: link/dedup migrant records lacking a national ID	Research study	IJPDS 2348

CONFIRMED NEGATIVE — checked, and NOT an adopter

-  **Statistics Canada** — the Canadian source discusses the UK's Splink work; it does **not** use Splink. (*statcan.gc.ca 11-522-X; PMC9645056*)

Searched — NO evidence of Splink adoption found

Stats NZ · Netherlands CBS · Statistics Norway · Statistics Sweden · Statistics Finland · Statistics Denmark · Germany Destatis · France INSEE · Spain INE · Italy ISTAT · Eurostat · Statistics Poland · Statistics Portugal · Brazil IBGE · South Africa StatsSA · India. (*Absence of a public record ≠ proof of non-use, but it is not a confirmed adopter.*)

Excluded

- **Credit scoring / credit bureaus** — UNVERIFIED across both passes. No source. Excluded.
 - US Census Bureau ↔ ONS appearing together = the **Fellegi-Sunter method's history** (originated at the US Census Bureau, 1969), **not Splink**.
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The honest count

- **Confirmed countries with ANY documented Splink use: 4** — UK (operational, multiple agencies), Australia (one operational system), US (one state pilot + two evaluators), Chile (one research study).
- **Operationally deep: the UK, essentially alone.**
- **Confirmed non-adopter: Canada. No evidence: ~16 other agencies checked.**
- **The true footprint is larger but undocumented** (open-source, anonymous downloads ~230k/month) — real, but unprovable per-country, so not named here.

What this means for the story

The strong, defensible version is **not** "the world is secretly running this on everyone." It's: *"The UK has built deep, operational, cross-domain citizen linkage on this tool — with no individual consent or notification — and it is beginning to spread (Australia operationally; pilots and studies in the US and Chile)."* That is true, sourced, and unkillable. The global-dragnet version is not supported by the documents and would be the first thing a critic dismantles.

Method: 2 deep-research passes, 200+ agent calls, 40+ sources, every claim majority-refutation-tested. Negative and null results reported, not hidden.